



JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE
Forensic Services Branch Policy and Standard Operating Procedures

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1.0 Introduction

The Jamaica Constabulary Force recognizes the critical role that forensic science plays in modern law enforcement, specifically criminal investigations. The increasing complexity of crimes, particularly those involving forensic and digital evidence, demands a more integrated and specialized forensic capability to house and manage the comprehensive body of knowledge and forensic investigators within the Jamaica Constabulary Force. The current structure limits the JCF’s ability to retain skilled forensic experts and have effective succession planning. Without proper recognition, opportunities for professional development and a clear path, the JCF risks continuing to lose valuable expertise essential to its crime fighting mission.

The Jamaica Constabulary Force in a bid to modernize its investigative approach, recognizes the need for restructuring of its forensic services to better address the challenges posed by both traditional and emerging crimes by consolidating and enhancing the forensic capabilities and expertise, hence the establishment of the Forensic Services Branch (FSB). Undeniably, the creation of this branch will lead to proactive investigative and operational responses rather than just being reactive, which currently exists. The FSB will provide a comprehensive range of forensic services, including digital and communication forensics, fingerprint analysis, ballistics, question document analysis and crime scene investigation.

2.0 Purpose

The purpose of the Forensic Services Branch is to strengthen the current gaps in service delivery by coordinating and management of shared resources of forensic investigators that will facilitate real-time communication, enhance confidence amongst stakeholders and reduce turned around time for the completion of investigations.

3.0 Scope

This policy and standard operating procedure shall apply to all members of the JCF Forensic Services Branch. It is an established guide for members in forensic services, including digital and communication forensics, fingerprint analysis, ballistics, question document analysis and crime scene investigation.

4.0 Policy Statement

- It is the policy of the JCF that the Forensic Services Branch will provide and effectively manage its investigation process through:
- 4.1 **Cross-functional Opportunities:** A centralized facility provides a dedicated space for continuous training, research, and development.
 - 4.2 **Foster Innovation:** A shared environment encourages cross-disciplinary innovation and problem-solving.
 - 4.3 **Reduce Costs:** Shared infrastructure and resources lower operational expenses.
 - 4.4 **Improved Quality and Productivity:** A branch dedicated to forensic services allows for better oversight, monitoring and quality products.

5.0 Abbreviations and Acronyms

CFCD	Communication Forensic and Cybercrime Division
FSB	Forensic Services Branch
SOC	Scenes Of Crime
TSD	Technical Services Division

6.0 Definitions

- 6.1 **Ballistics** is the forensic analysis of firearms, ammunition, projectiles and other related evidence.

- 6.2 **Ballistics Expert** shall have the same meaning as defined in the Firearms (Prohibition, Restriction and Regulation) Act, 2022.
- 6.3 **Behavioural Analysis**, also known as *modus operandi*, is the scientific study of behaviour, focusing on understanding why people behave the way they do, how behaviours can be changed, and how certain behaviours can be prevented using principles of learning theory.
- 6.4 **Communication Analysis** is the use of technology and analytical tools to extract actionable insights from emails, phone calls, and social media interactions, other forms of cyber data.
- 6.5 **Crime Scene Investigator** is a trained Forensic Crime Scene Officer competent in the art of evaluating, documenting and collecting physical evidence through interviewing, examining, photographing sketch and processing of crime scenes.
- 6.6 **Digital Forensic Examiner** is an expert who uses specialized tools and software to investigate digital devices for data and activity, which can be presented as evidence in legal proceedings.
- 6.7 **Fingerprint Analysis** is a forensic technique used to identify individuals by comparing the unique patterns of friction ridges (lines) on their fingertips, toes, palms, or soles.
- 6.8 **Forensic Intelligence** is the analysis of forensic data (e.g., from crime scenes, evidence, and investigations) to gain insights into criminal activity, trends, and patterns.
- 6.9 **Question Document Analysis** examination of documents that are under scrutiny and gives expert opinion on authenticity and authorship.

7.0 Responsibilities

The following summarizes key responsibilities:

- 7.1 **Deputy Commissioner of Police Crime and Security Portfolio** will give oversight and direction to the operations of the Forensic Services Branch.
- 7.2 **Assistant Commissioner of Police, Forensic Services Branch** will:
- 7.2.1 Consolidate and coordinate the forensic services force-wide, leveraging specialized knowledge to support investigation, intelligence and proactive policing.
 - 7.2.2 Provide oversight and management to all forensic investigations;
 - 7.2.3 Ensure adequate personnel are equipped with the required training to conduct the task effectively and efficiently.
 - 7.2.4 To coordinate and liaise with national, regional and international partners;
 - 7.2.5 Update on critical forensic investigations that are likely to be of national/international interest.
 - 7.2.6 Ensure that all forensic investigations are managed ethically in accordance with legal requirements, quality standards, policies & SOPs.
 - 7.2.7 Report to the DCP Crime & Security Portfolio on all matters pertaining to the branch.
 - 7.2.8 Ensure the procurement, distribution, and maintenance of forensic equipment, vehicles, and mobile crime labs.
 - 7.2.9 Coordinate forensic response teams for major crime scenes, mass casualty incidents, and critical investigations.

- 7.3 **Senior Director, Senior Superintendent of Police, Operations**
- 7.3.1 Operational Oversight & Coordination.
 - 7.3.2 Develop and implement operational systems to enhance the effectiveness and efficiency of forensic services.
 - 7.3.3 Ensure the forensic operations align with investigative needs and strategic priorities.
 - 7.3.4 Logistics & Resource Management.
 - 7.3.5 Maintenance of forensic equipment, vehicles, and mobile crime labs.
 - 7.3.6 Incident Response & Forensic Deployment.
 - 7.3.7 Ensure forensic units are mobilized in a timely and strategic manner for evidence collection and crime scene processing.
 - 7.3.8 Act as the operational lead for cross-divisional forensic responses
 - 7.3.9 Crime Scene & Evidence Management.
 - 7.3.10 Oversee adherence to forensic best practices in crime scene management, ensuring integrity and chain of custody of evidence.
 - 7.3.11 Inter-Branch & Cross-Divisional Collaboration.
 - 7.3.12 Facilitate intelligence sharing between forensic units and crime investigation teams.
 - 7.3.13 Conduct operational audits to ensure compliance with forensic policies and procedures.
 - 7.3.14 Provide regular reports to the Assistant Commissioner of Police (ACP) Forensics on the status and effectiveness of forensic operations.
 - 7.3.15 Monitor cross area investigations for forensic (DNA, ballistics and biometrics etc.) match reports.
 - 7.3.16 Review critical forensic investigations that are likely to be of national/international interest.
- 7.4 **Director, Superintendent of Police, Communication Forensics and Cybercrime Division**
- 7.4.1 Provide leadership for all administrative and operational functions within CFCD in keeping with the good order and guidance of the Jamaica Constabulary Force.
 - 7.4.2 Oversee the acquisition, storage, analysis, and dissemination of communications data and digital forensic evidence in accordance with legal and regulatory frameworks.
 - 7.4.3 Supervise and coordinate complex cybercrime investigations, including but not limited to incidents of hacking, identity theft, financial fraud, and other cybercrime offences.
 - 7.4.4 Ensure compliance with the Interception of Communications Act, Data Protection Act, Cybercrimes Act, and other relevant legislations governing digital forensics.
 - 7.4.5 Facilitate knowledge-sharing initiatives with internal and external stakeholders to strengthen proactive and responsive strategies to cyber threats and investigations.
 - 7.4.6 Work closely with judicial authorities, the Office of the Director of Public Prosecutions, and policymakers to ensure digital evidence is admissible in court and aligns with legal standards.
 - 7.4.7 Ensure that all digital forensic investigations comply with legal, ethical, and professional standards, mitigating risks associated with data privacy and human rights concerns.
 - 7.4.8 Contribute to the formulation of national cybersecurity policies and legislative reforms to strengthen Jamaica's cyber resilience.
 - 7.4.9 Make representations for adequate staffing, material resources and training.
 - 7.4.10 Maintenance of professional standards and accountability framework.
 - 7.4.11 Report to the Senior Director on all matters impacting the division.
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- 7.5 **Director, Superintendent of Police, Technical Services Division**
- 7.5.1 Provide leadership for all administrative and operational functions within TSD in keeping with the good order and guidance of the Jamaica Constabulary Force.
 - 7.5.2 Oversee the maintenance of a comprehensive and secure fingerprint database of all persons convicted in Jamaica and Jamaicans convicted of crimes overseas.
 - 7.5.3 Collaborate and manage crime scene investigations that may be of national interest.
 - 7.5.4 Ensure compliance with the relevant legislation and policies governing forensic services.
 - 7.5.5 Facilitate knowledge-sharing initiatives with internal and external stakeholders to strengthen proactive and responsive strategies to incidents that fall under the purview of the division.
 - 7.5.6 Work closely with judicial authorities, the Office of the Director of Public Prosecutions, and policymakers to ensure evidential continuity and the admissibility of physical evidence.
 - 7.5.7 Ensure that all digital forensic extractions comply with legal, ethical, and professional standards, mitigating risks associated with data privacy and human rights concerns.
 - 7.5.8 Make representations for adequate staffing, material resources and training.
 - 7.5.9 Maintenance of professional standards and accountability framework.
 - 7.5.10 Report to the Senior Director on all matters impacting the division.
- 7.6 **Deputy Superintendent of Police, Forensic Services Branch, Administrative Officer**
- 7.6.1 Provide management for all administrative functions within the Branch in keeping with the good order and guidance of the Jamaica Constabulary Force.
 - 7.6.2 Work closely with the Director of the Quality Assurance and Control Unit, oversee the training and development opportunities for the staff within the Branch.
 - 7.6.3 Maintain an internal HR database of the staff that tracks promotions, training, skillsets, discipline, leave, membership to professional bodies, and any other internal HR matters as designated by the ACP FSB.
- 7.7 **Deputy Superintendent of Police, Forensic Intelligence and Behavioural Analysis Unit**
- 7.7.1 Provide leadership for all administrative and operational functions within the unit in keeping with the good order and guidance of the Jamaica Constabulary Force.
 - 7.7.2 Oversee the collation, analysis and dissemination of data to inform investigations, trends and produce forensic intelligence briefs.
 - 7.7.3 Create and maintain a library of professional development materials.
 - 7.7.4 Facilitate knowledge-sharing initiatives with internal and external stakeholders to strengthen proactive and responsive strategies to incidents that fall under the purview of the Branch.
 - 7.7.5 Guide the research products contributing to the formulation and/ or amendment of legislation.
 - 7.7.6 Make representations for adequate staffing, material resources and training.
 - 7.7.7 Maintenance of professional standards and accountability framework.
 - 7.7.8 Report to the Senior Director on all matters impacting the unit.

- 7.8 Deputy Superintendent of Police, Ballistics**
- 7.8.1 Provide leadership for all administrative and operational functions within the unit in keeping with the good order and guidance of the Jamaica Constabulary Force.
 - 7.8.2 Oversee daily operations of the unit, ensuring compliance with national and international standards and best practices in ballistic examinations.
 - 7.8.3 Implement rigorous quality control and quality assurance protocols to maintain the integrity and reliability of forensic analyses and reports.
 - 7.8.4 Lead the adoption and integration of advanced ballistic identification systems and other innovative technologies to improve forensic examinations and data analysis.
 - 7.8.5 Represent the division in legal proceedings, public forums, and professional conferences, articulating the role and findings of forensic ballistics in criminal justice.
 - 7.8.6 Ensure ongoing professional development and training for division staff to keep abreast of the latest advancements and techniques in forensic ballistics.
- 7.9 Deputy Superintendent of Police, Scenes of Crime**
- 7.9.1 Provide leadership for all administrative and operational functions within the unit in keeping with the good order and guidance of the Jamaica Constabulary Force.
 - 7.9.2 Ensure that accurate and detailed records of crime scenes are maintained.
 - 7.9.3 Coordinate with other agencies, internal and external stakeholders to ensure a comprehensive investigation.
 - 7.9.4 Manage resources to ensure efficient and effective investigation.
 - 7.9.5 Ensure that all scenes of crime investigative activities are conducted in accordance with procedures outlined in the Major Crime Scene policy.
 - 7.9.6 Identify and recommend training needs for members within the Unit.
- 7.10 Deputy Superintendent of Police, Question Document**
- 7.10.1 Provide leadership for all administrative and operational functions within the unit in keeping with the good order and guidance of the Jamaica Constabulary Force.
 - 7.10.2 Coordinate with other stakeholders such as forensics investigations to ensure that all relevant information is gathered and analysed in a timely manner to aid investigations.
 - 7.10.3 Ensure statements taken from witnesses, victims and suspects are reviewed to ensure they are accurate, complete and relevant.
 - 7.10.4 Maintain accurate and up-to-date records of interrogations and all relevant documentation.
 - 7.10.5 Conduct quality control checks on all documents before submission for the courts.
- 7.11 Deputy Superintendent of Police, Fingerprint Bureau**
- 7.11.1 Provide leadership for all administrative and operational functions within the bureau in keeping with the good order and guidance of the Jamaica Constabulary Force.
 - 7.11.2 Working closely with the DSP of SoC, Criminal Records Office, courts, and any other internal or external partners to ensure the processing of fingerprints and the generation of the required reports.
 - 7.11.3 Ensure that fingerprint records are maintained in accordance with the Fingerprints Act and any other applicable policy and legislation.
 - 7.11.4 Ensure the acquisition and maintenance of the relevant equipment needed for processing.

7.11.5 Monitor and maintain the processing standards according to legislation and ethical standards.

7.12 Deputy Superintendent of Police, Quality Assurance and Control Unit

7.12.1 Provide leadership for all administrative and operational functions within the unit in keeping with the good order and guidance of the Jamaica Constabulary Force.

7.12.2 Developing the processes and procedures that will guide incident response within the divisions and Branch in accordance with JCF's Quality Management Policies.

7.12.3 Monitoring the quality of the work products of the FSB.

7.12.4 Oversee the supervision and resources of the Registry.

7.12.5 Communicating with the Courts and Office of the Director of Prosecutions to ensure that reports are received, and officers are available for court when needed.

7.12.6 Ensure that forensic personnel and facilities meet international best practices and certifications.

7.12.7 Monitoring the performance of the Branch's work plan.

7.12.8 Conduct site visits, audits and inspections, including visits to court and provide reports to the Director of Operations and the ACP FSB.

8.0 Roles and Function

The following outlines specific roles and functions:

8.1 Scenes of Crime Unit will:

8.1.1 Process crime scene and conduct evidence handling which includes protecting, preserving.

8.1.2 Identify, examine, document, collect and transmit physical evidence from crime/incident scenes.

8.1.3 Attend court and give evidence on crime scenes that have been processed and where evidence was collected.

8.2 Question Document Unit will:

8.2.1 Give expert testimony in court on the authenticity and authorship of documents that were examined by the unit.

8.2.2 Conduct handwriting analysis including identification of authorship, signature verification, forgery detection, ink elimination, indented writing, obliterations, erasures, and counterfeit notes.

8.2.3 Support fraud investigations as well as civil cases submitted to the unit by external customers.

8.3 Fingerprint Bureau will:

8.3.1 Maintain the criminal database which contains information on all persons convicted in Jamaica and Jamaicans convicted of crimes overseas.

8.3.2 Provides functions for the collection, classification, comparison and identification of individual's fingerprints in relation to latent marks that have been collected from crime scene.

8.3.3 Provide decentralized services in other formations which facilitate the collection of fingerprints and crime scene impressions which are transmitted to the centralized hub at TSD HQ.

8.3.4 Analyse, compare, evaluate and verify latent marks that have been retrieve from a crime scene.

8.4 Ballistics Unit will

- 8.4.1 Analyse markings on firearms, bullets, cartridge casings and other related evidence to provide ballistics evidence for the courts.
- 8.4.2 Provide crucial information used as leads for investigators through the output of microscopic comparison of ballistic evidence, the Integrated Ballistics Identification System (IBIS), Electronic Trace (eTrace) systems and other forensic ballistics tools.
- 8.4.3 Use chemical, magnetic or other methods to restore obliterated serial numbers on firearms.
- 8.4.4 Conduct shooting incident reconstruction to help determine the sequence of events that may have occurred during the incident.
- 1.1.1 Determine the status of seized firearms through the National Firearms Register.

8.5 Communication Forensic Unit will:

- 8.5.1 Investigate and analyse electronic communications (e.g., VoIP, CDRs, IPDRs) for evidence in criminal investigations.
- 8.5.2 Lawfully acquire communications data from Communication Service Providers (CSPs).
- 8.5.3 Conduct Cell Site Surveys to validate Cell Site Global Identity (CGI).
- 8.5.4 Investigate digital footprints on social media platforms for intelligence and evidence.
- 8.5.5 Liaise with social media platform in furtherance of social media investigation.

8.6 Mobile & Computer Forensics Unit will:

- 8.6.1 Retrieve deleted, encrypted, and hidden data from mobile devices.
- 8.6.2 Analyse call logs, text messages, app data, GPS data, and multimedia content.
- 8.6.3 Perform disk imaging and data recovery from damaged or wiped devices.
- 8.6.4 Analyse file systems, emails, documents, and browser histories for evidence.
- 8.6.5 Investigate cybercrimes such as hacking, data breaches, and intellectual property theft.

8.7 Video & Audio Forensics Unit will:

- 8.7.1 Analyse audio and visual evidence for authenticity, enhancement, and interpretation.
- 8.7.2 Examine video footage (e.g., CCTV, body cam) for tampering or alterations.
- 8.7.3 Enhance audio/video recordings for clarity and context.
- 8.7.4 Authenticate digital media to confirm its integrity and use in court proceedings.

9.0 Operational Structure of Forensic Branch

The Forensic Services Branch is committed to providing professional, impartial, and independent forensic investigation services to support the JCF's case management system.

9.1 Forensic Services Branch Headquarters

The FSB HQ will provide oversight, coordination, and management of forensic investigators' shared resources. It will facilitate real-time communication, identify current gaps in service delivery that could be researched, and implement better practices, resulting in enhanced confidence amongst stakeholders.

9.2 **Structure Composition of Forensic Services Branch**

The Branch will comprise of primary divisions with sub-units situated across specialized and geographic divisions with direct reporting responsibility to the respective Divisional and Unit Directors.

9.3 **Headquarters, Divisional and Administrative Functions**

The FSB, which comprises of a headquarters, with a minimum of two (2) divisions and two (2) units, will conduct both administrative and operational functions as follows:

9.3.1 **Technical Services Division**

Consisting of Forensic Crime Scene Investigations, Ballistics, Question Documents and Fingerprint Bureau, TSD is responsible for crime scene management in accordance with the Major Crime Scene Policy and Case Management Policy.

9.3.2 **Communication, Forensic and Cybercrime Division**

- a. The CFCD will support investigators and guide prosecutors to better use communication and digital data in evidence, by providing technical support in the form of extraction, examination, analysis, preparation and presentation of pertinent evidence in the capacity of expert witness testimony.
- b. These processes also entail the handling, processing, analysing, preparing and preserving digital evidence in a forensically sound manner in accordance with internationally acceptable standards., while ensuring that there is compliance with legal and regulatory requirements while maintaining the confidentiality, integrity, availability and security of digital evidence.

9.3.3 **Forensic Intelligence and Behavioural Analysis Unit**

The Forensic Intelligence and Behavioural Analysis Unit would include the inclusion of researchers, crime analysts, and behavioural analysts. Collectively this unit will be responsible compiling and collating data from all the forensic services, analyse for modus operandi, and produce research and briefs that can inform investigators and intelligence on the modus operandi of criminal actors. This approach will enhance the Focus Deterrence approach currently being utilised.

9.3.4 **The Quality Assurance and Control Unit**

The Quality Assurance and Control Unit will monitor the quality work conducted with the FSB, to include supervision of the Registry and communicating with the various courts offices and Office of the Director of Prosecutions to ensure that case files are submitted in the prescribed timelines.

9.4 **Decentralized Units within Areas and specialized formations are:**

9.4.1 **Scenes of Crime Units**

The functions include but are not limited to attendance, identification, examination, documentation, collection and transmittal of physical evidence from crime/incident scene or any matter that may be under investigation.

9.4.2 **The Serial Number Restoration Unit**

This unit operates out of Scenes of Crime (SOC) and primarily focuses on the restoration of obliterated/tampered chassis, vehicle identification number, and engine numbers which can be found on motor vehicles and any other items (wood, plastic, metals, etc.) with serial numbers.

9.4.3 **Question Documents Unit**

This unit specializes in handwriting analysis including identification of authorship, signature verification, forgery detection, ink elimination, indented writing, obliterations, erasures, as well as counterfeit notes, and called upon to give expert testimony in court on the authenticity and authorship of such a document that were examined.

9.4.4 **Fingerprint Bureau**

This unit provides functions for the collection, classification, comparison and identification of individual's fingerprints in relation to latent marks collected from crime scene, upon retrieval latent marks are analyzed, compared, evaluated and verified. The verification aspect of the process derives from the collaborative efforts of peer review help by members. . The unit utilizes forensic technologies such as the Multi Biometric Identification System (MBIS) to help establish identity and fast track the processing of fingerprint records.

9.4.5 **Ballistics, Forensic Lab**

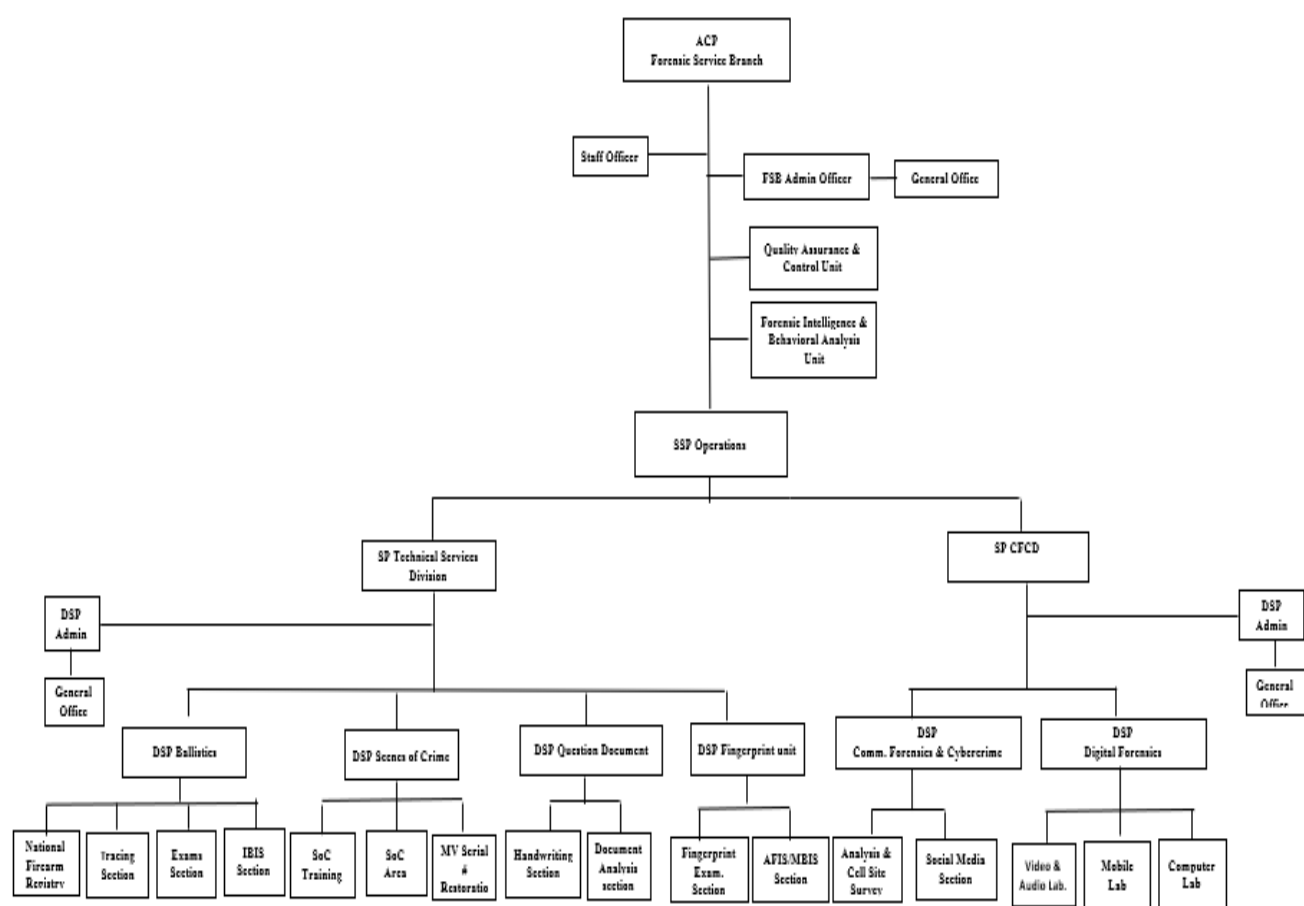
The Ballistics Unit conducts forensic examinations of firearms, ammunition, and ballistic evidence to support investigations. It also specializes in shooting incident reconstruction and serial number restoration, recovering obliterated markings on defaced firearms. The unit utilizes forensic technologies such as **the Integrated Ballistics Identification System (IBIS) to help establish links** between crime scenes and electronic tracing to identify illicit trafficking.

10.0 Legislative Authority/Guiding Principles

10.1 JCF Case Management Policy & Standard Operating Procedures

10.2 JCF Major Crime Scene Policy & Standard Operating Procedures

Appendix 1: Forensic Services Branch Chart



Appendix 2: Incident Response Workflow

The chart below shows the incident response workflow that will guide the incident response workflow from the time that the request is received in the branch to the disposal of the case.

